If I act a little strange
For I know not what I do

It had been another extraordinary Test match.

Australia had won the toss again and batted again, and scored an imposing 394 all out. Shortly after tea on the second day, we were floundering at 141 for six, almost out for the count, with nearly 50 000 spectators roaring their Australian team back into the series. JP stood firm and remained, and remained and, picking his team off the canvas, scored an unforgettable 166 as we rallied to reach 459 all out.

Morné Morkel had made 26, Paul Harris 39 and Dale Steyn had struck a glorious 76 from 191 balls in just under four hours at the crease. It was truly the fightback of all fightbacks, and the Australians, suddenly batting under pressure, could manage no more than 247 in their second innings. Ricky Ponting followed his first innings century with a typically defiant 99, but the match had turned decisively in our favour.

We were left with 183 runs to win the Test match and the series and, amid an almost surreal atmosphere, we reached the target for the loss of only one wicket soon after lunch on the fifth day. It was almost too much to take in. Australia had not lost a home Test series for 16 years of total dominance, but they had lost to us.

The celebrations followed and the champagne flowed long into the night, through another memorable team fines meeting, and more memorable times spent within the Proteas of 2008.

We had won 11 Tests in the calendar year, a feat matched at the time only by the West Indies in 1984 and England in 2004. We had completed an amazing 10 successful fourth-innings run chases of more than 175 runs during the year and Graeme Smith had contributed 913 runs to these undaunted pursuits.

Each player had played his full part in a settled squad and coach Mickey Arthur deserves high praise, but it was our captain who merited